

CSW Agent — Tanium Deployment Checklist

One-page field guide for deployment teams

May 2026

Repo: github.com/chandrapati/CSW-Agent-Installation-Guide · **Full runbook:** [tanium/README.md](#)

Critical rules

1. Linux and Windows are separate CSW downloads. In *Manage* → *Agents* → *Install Agent*, choose **OS = Linux** and download (.rpm/.deb/.sh + site files), then run the wizard again with **OS = Windows** and download (.msi ZIP + site files). Build **separate Tanium packages** — do not put Windows and Linux installers in one package.

2. Pre-stage user.cfg before install. Write the activation key in the install directory *before* Tanium runs any install command. Without it, the agent may install but stay *Not Active / unauthorized* in the CSW UI.

ACTIVATION_KEY=<from CSW UI → Manage → Agents → Install Agent>
HTTPS_PROXY=http://proxy.example.com:8080 # optional

Pre-flight (CSW admin)

Complete the block below **once per OS** (Linux download, then Windows download if both are in scope).

Step	Done
Confirm target tenant, scope, OS , and sensor type (Visibility vs Enforcement)	☐
Linux: wizard → OS Linux → pick distro/version → copy activation key → Download (.rpm or .deb or .sh + site files)	☐
Windows: new wizard run → OS Windows → copy activation key → Download (MSI ZIP + site files)	☐
Confirm outbound 443/TCP (and on-prem collector/enforcer ports if applicable)	☐
Configure EDR/AV exclusions on	☐

Step	Done
endpoints before deploy	
Create separate Tanium packages (Linux vs Windows; split RPM vs DEB if needed)	☐
Store each OS's activation key in that package's Tanium variable (not plain-text Git)	☐

Tanium packages (one per CSW download)

Tanium package	CSW download	Target group
CSW — Linux RHEL/Rocky (RPM)	OS Linux + RPM family	Linux RPM hosts only
CSW — Linux Ubuntu/Debian (DEB)	OS Linux + DEB family	Linux DEB hosts only
CSW — Windows	OS Windows + MSI ZIP	Windows hosts only

Package contents (same folder on every endpoint — per OS package)

File	Required
user.cfg (with ACTIVATION_KEY pre-staged)	Yes
ca.cert	Yes
site.cfg	Yes
sensor_config	Yes
sensor_type	Yes
enforcer.cfg	If enforcement
TetrationAgentInstaller.msi (Windows) or .rpm/.deb/.sh (Linux)	Yes

Suggested paths: Linux /opt/tanium/csw/ · Windows C:\Program Files\Tanium\csw\

Tanium Deploy package steps (order matters)

#	Package step	Done
1	Stage user.cfg — run stage-user-cfg script with	☐

#	Package step	Done
	CSW_ACTIVATION_KEY from Tanium variable	
2	Deploy full Cisco bundle (site files + installer) to install directory	☐
3	Install — Linux: tanium-linux- install.sh · Windows: tanium- windows- install.ps1	☐
4	Success criteria: exit code 0 + service Running (csw-agent / CswAgent)	☐
5	Pilot wave → production waves; confirm CSW UI shows host Running within 1–2 min	☐

Post-deploy verification

Check	Linux	Windows
Service running	systemctl is- active csw-agent	Get-Service CswAgent
CSW UI	<i>Manage</i> → <i>Agents</i> → <i>Software Agents</i> — status Running , correct scope	Same

If something fails

All platforms (Tanium)

Symptom	First action
<i>Not Active / unauthorized</i>	Confirm <code>user.cfg</code> with valid ACTIVATION_KEY existed before install step ran
Package step order wrong	Rebuild package: (1) stage user.cfg → (2) deploy bundle → (3) install
Key in Tanium variable empty	Fix secret variable binding; pilot on one host before fleet

Symptom	First action
Linux hosts get Windows MSI (or vice versa)	Wrong package targeted
OS not supported on Linux	.deb sent to RHEL or .rpm to Ubuntu

Linux

Symptom	First action
Install fails immediately	journalctl -u csw-agent -n 50; confirm user.cfg at /opt/tanium/csw/
TLS / cert errors	Re-ship ca.cert + full bundle from CSW UI
Service won't start	Check kernel-devel match: uname -r; check SELinux AVC denials
Network timeout	nc -zv <cluster> 443; open firewall per network prereq doc

Windows

Symptom	First action
MSI failure	Open %TEMP%\csw-agent-tanium-install.log; search Return value 3
Service not running	Get-Service CswAgent; check Application event log
EDR block (1722 / 1603)	Add Defender exclusions before redeploy
Network	Test-NetConnection <cluster> -Port 443; add HTTPS_PROXY to user.cfg if proxied

Full troubleshooting: [tanium/README.md](#) · [operations/06-troubleshooting.md](#)

Draft v1 — cross-check against the Cisco Secure Workload User Guide for your release before production use.